

Date: May 9, 2017 6:00 P.M.

Place: Brookline Town Hall, Room 111

Commissioners Attending: John Bain, Nancy O'Connor, Clara Batchelor, Daniel Lyons, Jim Carroll and Antonia Bellalta and Wendy Sheridan

Commissioners Absent:

Staff: Erin Gallentine, Parks and Open Space Director, Lisa Paradis, Recreation Director, Jessica White, Parks and Open Space Assistant.

TOPIC	KEY POINTS/DISCUSSION
Chairman's Welcome Approval of Minutes	J. Bain opened the meeting. N. O'Connor had a few spelling corrections. N. O'Connor moved for approval of the April 4, 2017 Park and Recreation Minutes. Seconded by J. Carroll. All in favor.
Public Comment	M. Paluszek addressed the Commission. He came into to try to ask for two things both of which are related to lighting at Pierce. The first request is that the Commission consider and move to propose in future projects, namely Cypress 2019 and Boylston Street 2020, that nighttime LED lighting at the basketball courts is part of the base line project for those two projects in the CIP. N. O'Connor stated that we could include a discussion of nighttime LED lighting. He understands that it could be out, but he wants to see it in the baseline funding request. He thinks that the court is beautiful, it is getting good use and providing wholesome activity. He stated that one thing that has become an issue is chewing gum on the courts. He would also like to see a trash can up there as well. The second request he has is to ask the Commission to revisit the hours at Pierce. He stated for the next 16 weeks with the 8:30 pm turn off time and with sunny days the lights will not go on. He thinks it won't be a true test for the bulk of the hours because the lights will only be on for half an hour or less until 8:30 pm. He presented a sunset chart for the Commission. He stated that there are lights on some soft ball fields and tennis courts in Town until 10 o'clock. N. O'Connor is not in favor of changing it right now. Her first thought is we need to see this play out. M.

	Paluszek stated that when you said give it a chance till 8:30pm that was with the understanding that the lights would be installed by December, the lights would be on for more than hour. He stated that we missed that opportunity and we are going to miss this opportunity. A. Bellalta stated that the pilot program is for a year and she would say we have to remember the rest of the voices that were in the room that were not too keen on having the lights on. She stated that we have to be sensitive and let the neighbors get used to the pilot program and see what the reception is like and then build it up. She stated if we just change we could get a lot of opposition. She thinks that we need to let people get used to the change. She understands M. Paluszek's point of view. J. Bain stated that we would really need to bring back the neighbors; we can't do anything like that without their input. He stated that we can take it under advisement and monitor it. M. Paluszek stated that it feels to people that they have had a bogus pilot project. N. O'Connor stated that it is not a bogus pilot program, we need to listen to the neighbors. She would not revisit the 10 o'clock request at this time. It is unfortunate we missed the cycle last year, but just because we missed it doesn't mean we should push it up until 10pm now. J. Bain stated that we will take it under advisement and thanked M. Paluszek for his time.	
Appointment of Chair and Vice Chair Positions	• D. Lyons moved to reappoint J. Bain as the Chair of the Park and Recreation Commission. Seconded by N O'Connor. All in favor. J. Bain abstained. • D. Lyons moved to reappoint N. O'Connor as Vice Chair of the Park and Recreation Commission. Seconded by C. Batchelor. All in favor. N. O'Connor abstained.	Chair/Vice Chair Votes
Introduction to Leigh Jackson, Assistant Recreation Director	• L. Paradis introduced Leigh Jackson as Assistant Director of Recreation. She stated that we found a wonderful Assistant Director for the Recreation Department. There were over 200 applicants for the position. L. Jackson was the first interview and she set	

	the bar very high. L. Jackson's previous position was with REI as New England Regional Director of Outdoor Education. She discussed her education and past employment. It is her second week on the job and has already made a great mark. She has an easy smile and a great laugh. She has great leadership qualities and is working so well with the staff. • Leigh Jackson is thrilled to be here. She saw the job, immediately pounced and is thrilled to be a part of it. She gave some background into her education and past employment. She is very much into wellness and health and hopes to increase programs of all ages to make all resident to be as healthy as they can be. She discussed the work that she did with REI. She hopes to be a resource for the Recreation Department and help to make Brookline a place to better place to live, work and play. • L. Paradis stated that over the course of the next six months we will be doing annual reports and that will be a nice introduction for L. Jackson. • L. Jackson and J. Bain discussed the pool. She stated that she has a lot to learn, she has a lot of ideas and it stated that it is going to be an exciting time. She stated that Soule has impressed her a great deal.	
Update on High School Expansion Project	• N. O'Connor stated that last week the BHS Expansion Building Committee voted on a preferred alternative. By 2021-2022 they are expecting 700 more students. She discussed the prices of the variations/ options that were being looked at. The Committee decided they want to look into another option which is the property at 111 Cypress; they are looking at purchasing it by eminent domain. That option is being looked at very favorably amongst the neighbors. There are a lot of things at the town level that need to happen, but right now they are expressing interest in taking 111 Cypress by eminent domain. The scheme presented would be built over the train tracks so that	

	the front of the building comes right onto Tappan Street. The Committee is talking about making it a freshman campus and calling it a 9th grade academy. The parking is yet to be determined. N O'Connor discussed the Tappan gym possible changes they could be making, it's not a Recreation controlled building but we use it. She discussed the amount of money that was being budgeted for that and there are a few of the Committee members pushing to get more and have more done in that building. A group of staff leaders from the High School and Recreation met to discuss needs and desires for that gym. She stated that it helped the chairs understand where we need to be. She stated right now there are 1200 student athletes out of 2000 students. N. O'Connor stated that they talked about the Tappan gym and Cypress Field. She stated that nothing is written in stone. She stated that when Cypress is renovated it will be renovated by the Park and Recreation Commission, there will be a design review process and it will be done with the Parks and Open Space Division. Timing and scope will be coordinated with the overall project. • Parking was discussed. • The slope was discussed. • D. Lyons and N. O'Connor discussed the Schluntz Gym. The locker rooms were discussed. • L. Paradis read a memo to the BHS Building Committee from Tina Bozeman, K-12 Coordinator for Physical Education and Peter Rittenberg, BHS Athletic Director and Lisa Paradis, Brookline Recreation Director. • L. Paradis also read out loud for the record a letter written in April 22nd 1968 to the Citizens of Brookline MA from President Johnson. • Arlene Mattison addressed the Commission. She stated that your recommendation is to treat Cypress and Schluntz gym equally, but the field is under Park and Recreation authority and the gym is totally within the School Department budget, so in terms of the	
--	--	--

	Building Committee and their recommendation they need to be made to two separate bodies. The Commission stated that is correct. She asked that in terms of the field the decisions you make will be part of a design review process, so if the parking was to be under the field that might impact the type of the material used on the field. • N. O'Connor stated that the parking will be discussed at a Building Expansion Committee Meeting and she stated that there has to be traffic study done. She doesn't think there is a desire to drive the budget up. A. Mattison asked if there is a sense that the consideration for an underground garage is being driven by abutters/ residents. She stated that it seems like we haven't talked about how much parking is needed for staff and other additional parking as well. N. O'Connor stated that there has been no discussion with needs of the parking, there is a traffic study underway and they will learn from that. The timing for the Design Review process for Cypress was discussed. • Deborah Rivers addressed the Commission. She attended the Transportation Board meeting last Monday. At that meeting the Transportation Board insisted a traffic demand management study be done as part of wrapping up the feasibility study. She will say that a Precinct Town Meeting member canvased the neighborhood and there is a lot of opposition in the neighborhood to a large underground parking facility under Cypress Field. That are concerned that will concentrate the traffic in that area. She is organizing neighbors so they can participate in the process. She stated that it is not clear how that design decision will be made. D. Lyons stated that at one of the presentations he mentioned a cost of parking for each level of underground parking. The price per level of parking was discussed.	
Recreation Update	• L. Paradis stated that the biggest thing to report on tonight is the ongoing capital improvement project at the pool. It is a	

	construction zone and they are doing best to keep it to a few weeks for closing. L. Paradis discussed some work has been completed on the decks and the basement structure. Everything is going well and there have been no surprises to date. The work is now being focused on the lobby area, the changing areas and locker rooms, adding family/gender fluid changing areas for patrons. It is going really well and in the end there will be nice improved amenities. There will be new graphics, paint and furniture. • International Yoga day is Tuesday, June 20th • Brookline Day is going to be Sunday, September 24th • Spring Sports are off to a rough start with the inclement weather and fields being closed. • Summer Camp registration is underway, it begins July 5th. • Amory and Waldstein Tennis courts have been opened. • The golf course is open and doing really well despite the rain.	
--	---	--

Park and Open Space Report

- Corey Hill Playground has commenced construction with contractor: Jamie T. Construction. E. Gallentine updated the Commission on the various stages of construction, submittal reviews and alterations made. She stated that the Design Review Committee, with great input from the public, had decided to put very little money into refurbishing the perimeter fence on the playground side because they wanted to invest in water play. The Division has straightened the pickets with the Town welder and is going to paint the fence towards the end of construction, however gates cannot be added to the fence at this time as they had hoped. The fence picket width is 4" and needs to be amended to meet current code. The entire fence, including picket alterations and gates, will need to be done at the same time. This is something that will need to be looked at in the future and may ultimately become a CIP expense. She will provide periodic updates as the project moves along. J. Bain and E. Gallentine discussed traffic calming.
- The Brookline Avenue Project is underway. Green Acres has been awarded the contract. The playground is closed right now, but the field is open. A little section was spaced off with temporary fencing being used for Brookline Early Education Program that is separate from the dogs. E. Gallentine accepted a gift of an integrated carousel that was given to the town from Play Brigade. The type of play elements for Brookline Avenue were shown to the Commission.
- An Emerson Garden update was given. Pulling the Emerson Garden bid package together was incredibly difficult given the timing of the Park and Recreation vote and immense work load of both the Park Division and Engineering Division. However, they were able to pull it all together, get it out to bid and have a successful low bidder. E. Gallentine will bring the contract to the Board of Selectman Tuesday of next week. She has worked successfully with this contractor in the past. She stated we are

	looking to break ground in June. E. Gallentine gave a quick review of the improvements, upgrades and the orientation/ reorganization of the play. E. Gallentine showed a model designed by Mitch Ryerson for Emerson. The model is a hut with boat and dock and will be made out of black locust. • A. Mattson and E. Gallentine discussed the entrances. • N. O'Connor stated that is she so grateful E. Gallentine reached out to Mitch Ryerson. She thinks it's an amazing piece and it's a great surprise that it could be done. • The schedule for Emerson was discussed. • A Brookline Reservoir Park update was given. The Design Review Committee will commence in June. The Design Team for this project consists of Annie Blair and Kathleen Fasser. The survey is complete. Art Vogt, Architect, was brought on board to analyze feasibility of restroom options in the gatehouse. She has invited Dennis Dewitt to get his input on this project. She needs to figure out if we are building a new structure or can we have an appropriate reuse of the structure that is there. • A Harry Downes Field and Playground update was given. Jessie Waisnor will be the Landscape Architect on the project. They have requested a quote for the survey. • E. Gallentine is working with Roll Barressi for an appropriate donor recognition tribute that will be in the front of Fisher Hill. She has come up with a whole host of ideas but she needs the design help of Roll Barressi to help appropriately recognize the donors who made contributions to the Fisher Hill Project. This project will be worked on through summer. The spring tree and shrub planting is complete. The drought was awful and took a toll on the plants and trees. The dry meadow reseeding is complete. The wet meadow will be worked on in the fall. E. Gallentine stated that we will install bollards at the entrance. There has been evidence of people driving onto the field. She stated that she is continuing to work on opportunities for advancing	
--	---	--

	restoration work at the gate house. They are applying for a Plumbing Board variance that is required to install little café style tables in the Gate House. • A. Bellalta and E. Gallentine discussed the field. • Lawton Playground Community Garden will be constructed this summer into the fall. • E. Gallentine hoped to open Pierce playground by June 10th but the field is not ready. E. Gallentine will be order bike racks. The basketball court Led lights at Pierce are operational, the signs are up that have rules and regulations and explain the Park and Recreation pilot. N. O'Connor asked E. Gallentine to please make sure trash receptacles go up in the basketball courts. D. Lyons stated that he has driven by and seen people playing behind construction fence. E. Gallentine discussed the service calls she received with people in the park when they shouldn't be and the breaches in the fence continue to be fixed. • At the community garden in Larz Anderson park E. Gallentine's crew has built a handicap accessible plot. There are repairs at the entry that need work. A new fountain was installed last week, the new fountain and aerator are up and running. The new seasonal rangers are cleaning out the lagoon. There will be an annual treatment for algae in the lagoon. The pruning and invasive removal continues up at Larz Anderson. • A Community Planning update was given. E. Gallentine discussed Gateway East, 700 Brookline Avenue and Coolidge Corner. • Phase one of the Emerald Necklace Bike Ped crossing is complete. It has gotten tremendous use and E. Gallentine has received mostly positive feedback. E. Gallentine discussed the plantings and lighting. E. Gallentine stated that we still have improvements to make with the timing and signalization itself. It has been very challenging. • The Olmsted Tree Society matched the Town dollar for dollar for all the work that is done at the Emerald Necklace. They are paying for	
--	---	--

	\$24,000 worth work of tree pruning this spring in Olmsted Park and the Riverway. • A Riverway Park update was given. • The Mike and Kitty Dukakis Dedication is Tuesday, June 13th at 1:30 pm The Plinth is in. • A Muddy River Restoration Project update was given. There was a ribbon cutting for phase one. The design is at 65 percent, it will be out to bid 2018. Phase three is flood mitigation. Gallentine discussed spot dredging. They will restore the landscape in a proper way where they impact the landscape. • The Carlton Street footbridge is in the Department of Transportation Plan for FY19. • A picture of the Thomas Hennessey field plaque was shared with the Commission. • E. Gallentine discussed the open space plan. J. Carroll is the park and Recreation Commission's representative. They are coming to the end of their process for putting together the action plan, goals and objectives. She pulled out a few that she thought she should bring to the commission's attention and listed them for the Commission • J. Bain stated that he has been sitting here watching all the projects and everything we are doing with park and open space and he has to say he doesn't now two people that are more dedicated than the Mattison's. The Town is very fortunate to have folks like them watching over the town. He appreciates their commitment and dedication for many things. The Commission all agreed. • E. Gallentine discussed a memo regarding the process for changing the use of both Land and Conservation Water Fund and Article 97 protect land.	
CIP Discussion and Vote	• The Capital Improvement Plan was shared with the Commission. • She stated Cypress has design money in 2019 and construction money in 2020. She wanted to mention that HMFH has met with E. Gallentine, L Paradis and a whole host of folks and has a whole list of improvements. E. Gallentine is reviewing their estimate now.	

	• Harry Downes has design money in 2017 and construction in 2019. • The Kraft's Athletic Facility has design money in FY2020 and construction money in FY2021. That is to resurface both the track and synthetic turf field. E. Gallentine described the work that would be done to the field. They are proposing organic infill. The playground and athletic field can be done in two phases. There was a comment from a resident to see if we can maybe ask the Kraft family for a grant. • Health School Playground design and construction money are in future years. • Larz Anderson Park is coming forward FY2019, FY2020 and FY2021 and future years. She stated we are waiting for 2020 to do the roadway reconstruction that work, so all the work can be done together. The money in FY19 focuses on bridges, the tempietto and the lagoon. • Murphy playground has Construction Money for FY2019. • Robinson is moving forward FY2020 with design and FY21 for construction. • Schick Park is FY2021 with design and FY2020 with construction. • Soule Park has design money in FY2019 and construction money in FY2020 • Boylston and Griggs parks are both in for future years • There has been a change in the CIP Process. The Planning Board is going to review capital projects at the beginning of the process instead of at the end, which will allow them time to ask questions and provide guidance. E. Gallentine will present to the Planning Board in June, the projects will still be advertised and be presented to the Commission for a full vote in September. She is looking for a vote this evening from the Commission with the understanding that the Commission knows what E. Gallentine is putting forward, that these are the same projects year after year and they are moving their way forward. • E. Gallentine discussed the work that is being done with the Office of Dam Safety and the	
--	---	--

	requirements that need to be done to be compliant with the Office of Dame Safety Rules and Regulations. They are looking just for a grass berm that can be easily inspected and the Town is pushing back. The town is presenting a list of options and is hoping for some compromise. She stated that we will be repointing the entire basin, rebuilding the track and making a handicap accessible entrance. • E. Gallentine shared photos of the current conditions of Brookline Reservoir, Downs field and Playground, Murphy Park, Shick Park, Robinson Playground, Kraft Athletic field (organic infill was discussed), Griggs park, Larz Anderson Park and Cypress Playground. • The breakdown of Kraft field was discussed. The maintenance of the field was discussed. E. Gallentine is going to push this item forward so that we line it up with the rest of work at Harry Downes Playground. The Commission discussed items in the CIP that could possibly pushed out to allow for Kraft Field to move up in the CIP. • Skyline Park was discussed. • W. Sheridan discussed grass vs. turf usage. • E. Gallentine discussed the vigorous program for the grass field. • The use of the athletic grass field should they be synthetic vs natural grass. Which ones do you think should be synthetic and why and how can we keep grass field in better condition. She thinks it would be worthwhile put together a committee. • E. Gallentine discussed the Phases of work for Larz Anderson. • E. Gallentine and N. O'Connor discussed where the capital improvement money comes from. • E. Gallentine is requesting that we increase the Cypress Playground and Field estimate per recommendation of HMFH, that we advance Griggs Park and Boylston Street Playground in the CIP, that we add Skyline Park synthetic turf replacement to CIP, the Kraft Family Athletic Facility be moved forward even if it means moving Murphy out due to condition, we add	
--	---	--

	Amory Tennis courts reconstruction to the CIP, that we add Halls Pond Boardwalk, refurbish the parking lot and make drainage improvements. E. Gallentine this summer is going to work with the School Committee to go over all the school playgrounds and put estimates together for them for what is required for renovations E. Gallentine is recommending that Driscoll School Playground be put in the CIP as well. • J. Bain moved to support the CIP and the recommendations that E. Gallentine has presented here tonight. Seconded by N. O'Connor. All in favor.	
Appointment of Harry Downes Playground Design Review Committee	• Wendy Sheridan, D. Lyons, J Bain and A. Bellalta were appointed to the Harry Downes Playground Design Review Committee	
Other Business	• E. Gallentine handed out the Brookline Parks and Open Space / Recreation Executive Master Plan Strategic Summary. The plan was approved in 2006 and she stated that we are due for a supplemental update to this plan at some point in the future. It has the mission statement for both the Park and Open Space and Recreation Department.	
Adjourn	• C. Batchelor moved to adjourn. Seconded W. Sherdian. All in favor.	

Next Meeting: June 13, 2017

Location: Town Hall, Room 111

A true record

Attest Jessica White

Date: 5/9/2017